

B1 German Grammar Practice Notebook

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Complete Study Guide with Examples in All Tenses

Introduction

This comprehensive notebook contains all essential grammar topics required for B1 German proficiency. Each topic includes detailed explanations, examples in multiple tenses, and English translations to support your learning journey.

How to Use This Notebook:

- Study one topic at a time
- Practice creating your own sentences using the patterns shown
- Focus on areas where you need more practice
- Use the examples as templates for your own writing

1. The Four Cases (Die vier Fälle)

The German case system is fundamental to proper grammar. Each case has a specific function and determines article and adjective endings.

Nominative Case (Nominativ) - The Subject

Function: Subject of the sentence, predicate nominative

Present: [translate:Der Mann isst einen Apfel.] - The man eats an apple.

Perfect: [translate:Der Mann hat einen Apfel gegessen.] - The man has eaten an apple.

Imperfect: [translate:Der Mann aß einen Apfel.] - The man ate an apple.

Future: [translate:Der Mann wird einen Apfel essen.] - The man will eat an apple.

More Examples:

- [translate:Die Frau arbeitet im Büro.] - The woman works in the office.
- [translate:Das Kind spielt im Garten.] - The child plays in the garden.
- [translate:Wer ist das?] - Who is that?

Accusative Case (Akkusativ) - Direct Object

Function: Direct object, object of accusative prepositions, time expressions

Present: [translate:Ich sehe den Hund.] - I see the dog.

Perfect: [translate:Ich habe den Hund gesehen.] - I have seen the dog.

Imperfect: [translate:Ich sah den Hund.] - I saw the dog.

Future: [translate:Ich werde den Hund sehen.] - I will see the dog.

With Prepositions:

- [translate:Ich gehe durch den Park.] - I walk through the park.
- [translate:Das Geschenk ist für dich.] - The gift is for you.
- [translate:Wir fahren ohne das Auto.] - We drive without the car.

Dative Case (Dativ) - Indirect Object

Function: Indirect object, object of dative prepositions, with certain verbs

Present: [translate:Ich gebe dem Kind einen Ball.] - I give the child a ball.

Perfect: [translate:Ich habe dem Kind einen Ball gegeben.] - I have given the child a ball.

Imperfect: [translate:Ich gab dem Kind einen Ball.] - I gave the child a ball.

Future: [translate:Ich werde dem Kind einen Ball geben.] - I will give the child a ball.

With Prepositions:

- [translate:Ich komme aus der Schule.] - I come from school.
- [translate:Er wohnt bei seinen Eltern.] - He lives with his parents.
- [translate:Wir fahren mit dem Zug.] - We travel by train.

Genitive Case (Genitiv) - Possession

Function: Possession, object of genitive prepositions

Present: [translate:Das Auto des Mannes ist neu.] - The man's car is new.

Perfect: [translate:Das Auto des Mannes ist neu gewesen.] - The man's car has been new.

Imperfect: [translate:Das Auto des Mannes war neu.] - The man's car was new.

Future: [translate:Das Auto des Mannes wird neu sein.] - The man's car will be new.

More Examples:

- [translate:Die Farbe des Hauses gefällt mir.] - I like the color of the house.
- [translate:Während des Urlaubs waren wir glücklich.] - During the vacation, we were happy.

2. German Tenses (Deutsche Zeitformen)

Present Tense (Präsens)

Uses: Current actions, general facts, near future

Regular Verbs:

- [translate:Ich lerne Deutsch.] - I am learning German.
- [translate:Du spielst Fußball.] - You play football.
- [translate:Wir wohnen in Berlin.] - We live in Berlin.

Irregular Verbs:

- [translate:Ich bin Student.] - I am a student.
- [translate:Er hat ein Auto.] - He has a car.
- [translate:Sie wird Lehrerin.] - She becomes a teacher.

Perfect Tense (Perfekt)

Uses: Completed past actions (conversational past)

With haben:

- [translate:Ich habe gestern Pizza gegessen.] - I ate pizza yesterday.
- [translate:Sie hat das Buch gelesen.] - She has read the book.
- [translate:Wir haben lange gewartet.] - We waited for a long time.

With sein:

- [translate:Ich bin nach Berlin gefahren.] - I went to Berlin.
- [translate:Er ist spät gekommen.] - He came late.
- [translate:Sie sind zu Hause geblieben.] - They stayed at home.

Imperfect Tense (Präteritum)

Uses: Past actions in written German, with sein/haben/modal verbs

Essential Verbs:

- [translate:Ich war gestern im Kino.] - I was at the cinema yesterday.
- [translate:Wir hatten keine Zeit.] - We had no time.

- [translate:Sie konnte nicht kommen.] - She couldn't come.

Narrative Past:

- [translate:Es war einmal ein König.] - Once upon a time there was a king.
- [translate:Der Zug kam pünktlich an.] - The train arrived on time.

Future Tense (Futur I)

Uses: Future actions, predictions, assumptions

Formation: werden + infinitive

- [translate:Ich werde morgen nach Hamburg fahren.] - I will go to Hamburg tomorrow.
- [translate:Es wird bald regnen.] - It will rain soon.
- [translate:Sie werden Erfolg haben.] - They will be successful.

Pluperfect (Plusquamperfekt)

Uses: Past actions before other past actions

Formation: hatte/war + past participle

- [translate:Ich hatte schon gegessen, als er kam.] - I had already eaten when he came.
- [translate:Sie waren schon gegangen, bevor wir ankamen.] - They had already left before we arrived.
- [translate:Nachdem er das Buch gelesen hatte, ging er schlafen.] - After he had read the book, he went to sleep.

3. Modal Verbs (Modalverben)

Modal verbs express ability, necessity, permission, desire, or obligation.

können (can, to be able to)

Present: [translate:Ich kann schwimmen.] - I can swim.

Perfect: [translate:Ich habe schwimmen können.] - I have been able to swim.

Imperfect: [translate:Ich konnte schwimmen.] - I could swim.

Future: [translate:Ich werde schwimmen können.] - I will be able to swim.

Konjunktiv II: [translate:Ich könnte schwimmen.] - I could swim (hypothetical).

Usage Examples:

- **Ability:** [translate:Sie kann sehr gut Deutsch sprechen.] - She can speak German very well.
- **Possibility:** [translate:Das kann richtig sein.] - That can be correct.
- **Permission:** [translate:Du kannst nach Hause gehen.] - You can go home.

müssen (must, to have to)

Present: [translate:Ich muss arbeiten.] - I have to work.

Perfect: [translate:Ich habe arbeiten müssen.] - I have had to work.

Imperfect: [translate:Ich musste arbeiten.] - I had to work.

Future: [translate:Ich werde arbeiten müssen.] - I will have to work.

Konjunktiv II: [translate:Ich müsste arbeiten.] - I would have to work.

Usage Examples:

- **Necessity:** [translate:Wir müssen pünktlich sein.] - We must be punctual.

- **Assumption:** [translate:Er muss krank sein.] - He must be sick.

wollen (to want to)

Present: [translate:Ich will nach Hause gehen.] - I want to go home.

Perfect: [translate:Ich habe nach Hause gehen wollen.] - I have wanted to go home.

Imperfect: [translate:Ich wollte nach Hause gehen.] - I wanted to go home.

Future: [translate:Ich werde nach Hause gehen wollen.] - I will want to go home.

Usage Examples:

- **Desire:** [translate:Sie will Ärztin werden.] - She wants to become a doctor.
- **Intention:** [translate:Wir wollen morgen früh aufstehen.] - We want to get up early tomorrow.

sollen (should, to be supposed to)

Present: [translate:Du sollst pünktlich sein.] - You should be punctual.

Perfect: [translate:Du hast pünktlich sein sollen.] - You should have been punctual.

Imperfect: [translate:Du solltest pünktlich sein.] - You were supposed to be punctual.

Future: [translate:Du wirst pünktlich sein sollen.] - You will be supposed to be punctual.

Usage Examples:

- **Advice:** [translate:Sie sollten mehr Gemüse essen.] - You should eat more vegetables.
- **Obligation:** [translate:Er soll um 8 Uhr da sein.] - He's supposed to be there at 8 o'clock.

dürfen (may, to be allowed to)

Present: [translate:Ich darf hier rauchen.] - I may smoke here.

Perfect: [translate:Ich habe hier rauchen dürfen.] - I have been allowed to smoke here.

Imperfect: [translate:Ich durfte hier rauchen.] - I was allowed to smoke here.

Future: [translate:Ich werde hier rauchen dürfen.] - I will be allowed to smoke here.

Usage Examples:

- **Permission:** [translate:Darf ich reinkommen?] - May I come in?
- **Prohibition:** [translate:Hier darf man nicht parken.] - One may not park here.

mögen/möchten (to like/would like)

Present: [translate:Ich möchte ein Bier.] - I would like a beer.

Perfect: [translate:Ich habe ein Bier gewollt.] - I have wanted a beer.

Imperfect: [translate:Ich mochte Bier.] - I liked beer.

Future: [translate:Ich werde ein Bier mögen.] - I will like beer.

Usage Examples:

- **Polite request:** [translate:Ich möchte gerne bezahlen.] - I would like to pay, please.
- **Preference:** [translate:Sie mag klassische Musik.] - She likes classical music.

4. Word Order and Sentence Structure

German word order follows specific rules that change depending on the type of clause.

Main Clause Word Order

Position 1 - Position 2 (Verb) - Middle Field - End Position

Standard Order (Subject first):

- [translate:Ich trinke jeden Morgen Kaffee.] - I drink coffee every morning.
- [translate:Die Kinder spielen im Garten.] - The children play in the garden.

Inverted Order (Time/Place first):

- [translate:Morgen fahre ich nach Berlin.] - Tomorrow I'm going to Berlin.
- [translate:Gestern hat es stark geregnet.] - Yesterday it rained heavily.
- [translate:In Deutschland lernt man viel über Geschichte.] - In Germany one learns a lot about history.

Perfect Tense Word Order

- [translate:Ich habe gestern einen interessanten Film gesehen.] - I saw an interesting movie yesterday.
- [translate:Sie ist letztes Jahr nach Amerika geflogen.] - She flew to America last year.
- [translate:Wir haben lange auf den Bus gewartet.] - We waited a long time for the bus.

Modal Verb Word Order

- [translate:Ich kann heute nicht kommen.] - I can't come today.
- [translate:Du musst deine Hausaufgaben machen.] - You must do your homework.
- [translate:Wir wollen am Wochenende ins Kino gehen.] - We want to go to the cinema on the weekend.

Questions

W-Questions:

- [translate:Wann kommst du nach Hause?] - When are you coming home?
- [translate:Wo wohnen Sie?] - Where do you live?
- [translate:Was machst du heute Abend?] - What are you doing tonight?

Yes/No Questions:

- [translate:Kommst du heute Abend?] - Are you coming tonight?
- [translate:Hast du Zeit?] - Do you have time?
- [translate:Können Sie mir helfen?] - Can you help me?

Subordinate Clause Word Order (Verb at the end)

- [translate:Ich denke, dass er Recht hat.] - I think that he is right.
- [translate:Sie bleibt zu Hause, weil es regnet.] - She stays home because it's raining.
- [translate:Wenn ich Zeit habe, komme ich gerne.] - If I have time, I'll gladly come.

5. Separable Verbs (Trennbare Verben)

Separable verbs have prefixes that separate in main clauses but stay attached in subordinate clauses.

Present Tense (Prefix separates)

- [translate:Ich stehe jeden Tag um 7 Uhr auf.] - I get up every day at 7 o'clock.
- [translate:Der Zug fährt um 9 Uhr ab.] - The train departs at 9 o'clock.
- [translate:Sie macht das Fenster zu.] - She closes the window.
- [translate:Wir kaufen heute ein.] - We go shopping today.

Perfect Tense

- [translate:Ich bin um 7 Uhr aufgestanden.] - I got up at 7 o'clock.
- [translate:Der Zug ist um 9 Uhr abgefahren.] - The train departed at 9 o'clock.
- [translate:Sie hat das Fenster zugemacht.] - She closed the window.
- [translate:Wir haben heute eingekauft.] - We went shopping today.

Future Tense

- [translate:Ich werde um 7 Uhr aufstehen.] - I will get up at 7 o'clock.
- [translate:Der Zug wird um 9 Uhr abfahren.] - The train will depart at 9 o'clock.
- [translate:Wir werden heute einkaufen.] - We will go shopping today.

In Subordinate Clauses (Prefix doesn't separate)

- [translate:Ich weiß, dass ich um 7 Uhr aufstehe.] - I know that I get up at 7 o'clock.
- [translate:Er sagt, dass der Zug um 9 Uhr abfährt.] - He says that the train departs at 9 o'clock.
- [translate:Sie möchte, dass wir heute einkaufen.] - She wants us to go shopping today.

Common Separable Verbs

- [translate:anrufen] - to call
- [translate:aufstehen] - to get up
- [translate:einkaufen] - to shop
- [translate:mitkommen] - to come along
- [translate:zurückkommen] - to come back
- [translate:fernsehen] - to watch TV
- [translate:aufhören] - to stop
- [translate:anfangen] - to begin

6. Reflexive Verbs (Reflexive Verben)

Reflexive verbs are used with reflexive pronouns and describe actions done to oneself.

Reflexive Pronouns

- **mich/mir** (myself)
- **dich/dir** (yourself)
- **sich** (himself/herself/itself/yourself formal)
- **uns** (ourselves)
- **euch** (yourselves)
- **sich** (themselves)

Examples in Different Tenses

Present:

- [translate:Ich wasche mich jeden Morgen.] - I wash myself every morning.
- [translate:Du erinnerst dich an mich.] - You remember me.
- [translate:Er rasiert sich.] - He shaves (himself).
- [translate:Wir interessieren uns für Musik.] - We are interested in music.

Perfect:

- [translate:Ich habe mich gewaschen.] - I have washed myself.
- [translate:Du hast dich an mich erinnert.] - You have remembered me.
- [translate:Er hat sich rasiert.] - He has shaved.
- [translate:Wir haben uns für Musik interessiert.] - We have been interested in music.

Future:

- [translate:Ich werde mich waschen.] - I will wash myself.
- [translate:Du wirst dich an mich erinnern.] - You will remember me.
- [translate:Wir werden uns für Musik interessieren.] - We will be interested in music.

Common Reflexive Verbs

- [translate:sich freuen auf] - to look forward to
- [translate:sich ärgern über] - to be annoyed about
- [translate:sich entscheiden für] - to decide on
- [translate:sich gewöhnen an] - to get used to
- [translate:sich verlieben in] - to fall in love with
- [translate:sich vorstellen] - to introduce oneself/imagine
- [translate:sich beeilen] - to hurry
- [translate:sich ausruhen] - to rest

Examples with Prepositions

- [translate:Ich freue mich auf das Wochenende.] - I look forward to the weekend.
- [translate:Sie ärgert sich über den Lärm.] - She is annoyed about the noise.
- [translate:Wir haben uns für das Auto entschieden.] - We decided on the car.
- [translate:Er hat sich an das Wetter gewöhnt.] - He has gotten used to the weather.

7. Passive Voice (Passiv)

The passive voice is used when the focus is on the action rather than who performs it.

Vorgangspassiv (Process Passive) - werden + past participle

Present Passive:

- [translate:Der Brief wird geschrieben.] - The letter is being written.
- [translate:Das Haus wird gebaut.] - The house is being built.
- [translate:Die Autos werden repariert.] - The cars are being repaired.

Perfect Passive:

- [translate:Der Brief ist geschrieben worden.] - The letter has been written.
- [translate:Das Haus ist gebaut worden.] - The house has been built.
- [translate:Die Autos sind repariert worden.] - The cars have been repaired.

Imperfect Passive:

- [translate:Der Brief wurde geschrieben.] - The letter was written.
- [translate:Das Haus wurde gebaut.] - The house was built.
- [translate:Die Autos wurden repariert.] - The cars were repaired.

Future Passive:

- [translate:Der Brief wird geschrieben werden.] - The letter will be written.
- [translate:Das Haus wird gebaut werden.] - The house will be built.
- [translate:Die Autos werden repariert werden.] - The cars will be repaired.

Zustandspassiv (State Passive) - sein + past participle

Present State:

- [translate:Der Brief ist geschrieben.] - The letter is written (state).
- [translate:Die Tür ist geöffnet.] - The door is open.
- [translate:Das Problem ist gelöst.] - The problem is solved.

Past State:

- [translate:Der Brief war geschrieben.] - The letter was written (state).
- [translate:Die Tür war geöffnet.] - The door was open.
- [translate:Das Problem war gelöst.] - The problem was solved.

Passive with Modal Verbs

- [translate:Die Tür muss geöffnet werden.] - The door must be opened.
- [translate:Das Problem kann gelöst werden.] - The problem can be solved.
- [translate:Die Arbeit soll gemacht werden.] - The work should be done.
- [translate:Der Brief darf nicht gelesen werden.] - The letter may not be read.

Von vs. Durch in Passive

Von (by - agent):

- [translate:Der Brief wurde von meinem Bruder geschrieben.] - The letter was written by my brother.

Durch (by means of - means):

- [translate:Die Stadt wurde durch den Sturm zerstört.] - The city was destroyed by the storm.

8. Konjunktiv II (Subjunctive Mood)

Used for hypothetical situations, polite requests, wishes, and unreal conditions.

Formation with würde + infinitive

Present Subjunctive:

- [translate:Ich würde gerne ein neues Auto kaufen.] - I would like to buy a new car.
- [translate:Sie würde in den Urlaub fahren, wenn sie Zeit hätte.] - She would go on vacation if she had time.
- [translate:Wir würden gerne mitkommen.] - We would like to come along.

Common Subjunctive Forms

haben → hätte:

- [translate:Wenn ich mehr Zeit hätte, würde ich reisen.] - If I had more time, I would travel.
- [translate:Ich hätte gerne ein Bier.] - I would like a beer.
- [translate:Hättest du Lust auf Kino?] - Would you like to go to the cinema?

sein → wäre:

- [translate:Wenn ich du wäre, würde ich das nicht machen.] - If I were you, I wouldn't do that.
- [translate:Es wäre schön, wenn du kommen könntest.] - It would be nice if you could come.
- [translate:Ich wäre gerne Pilot geworden.] - I would have liked to become a pilot.

können → könnte:

- [translate:Könnten Sie mir helfen?] - Could you help me?
- [translate:Ich könnte morgen kommen.] - I could come tomorrow.
- [translate:Wir könnten zusammen essen gehen.] - We could go eat together.

Past Subjunctive (Konjunktiv II Vergangenheit)

- [translate:Wenn ich früher gekommen wäre, hätte ich dich gesehen.] - If I had come earlier, I would have seen you.
- [translate:Sie wäre gerne mitgekommen, aber sie hatte keine Zeit.] - She would have liked to come along, but she had no time.
- [translate:Wenn es nicht geregnet hätte, wären wir spazieren gegangen.] - If it hadn't rained, we would have gone for a walk.

Wishes and Regrets

- [translate:Wenn ich nur mehr Geld hätte!] - If only I had more money!
- [translate:Wäre ich nur früher aufgestanden!] - If only I had gotten up earlier!
- [translate:Wenn er nur anrufen würde!] - If only he would call!

Polite Requests

- [translate:Könnten Sie mir bitte helfen?] - Could you please help me?
- [translate:Würden Sie das Fenster öffnen?] - Would you open the window?
- [translate:Hätten Sie einen Moment Zeit?] - Would you have a moment?

9. Infinitive Clauses with "zu"

Used when the subject of both clauses is the same or when the infinitive depends on certain verbs, adjectives, or nouns.

After Certain Verbs

- [translate:Ich habe vor, morgen zu kommen.] - I plan to come tomorrow.
- [translate:Sie versucht, Deutsch zu lernen.] - She tries to learn German.
- [translate:Wir hoffen, bald fertig zu sein.] - We hope to be finished soon.
- [translate:Er verspricht, pünktlich zu sein.] - He promises to be punctual.

After Adjectives + sein

- [translate:Es ist wichtig, pünktlich zu sein.] - It's important to be punctual.
- [translate:Es ist schwer, Deutsch zu lernen.] - It's hard to learn German.
- [translate:Es ist möglich, das zu schaffen.] - It's possible to manage that.
- [translate:Es ist schön, dich zu sehen.] - It's nice to see you.

After haben + noun

- [translate:Ich habe Lust, ins Kino zu gehen.] - I feel like going to the cinema.
- [translate:Sie hat Angst, allein zu sein.] - She's afraid of being alone.
- [translate:Wir haben Zeit, das zu machen.] - We have time to do that.
- [translate:Er hat die Möglichkeit, zu studieren.] - He has the opportunity to study.

With Separable Verbs

- [translate:Ich versuche, früh aufzustehen.] - I try to get up early.
- [translate:Sie plant, heute auszugehen.] - She plans to go out today.
- [translate:Wir haben vergessen, einzukaufen.] - We forgot to go shopping.

Common Verbs with zu-Infinitive

- [translate:beginnen zu] - to begin to
- [translate:aufhören zu] - to stop
- [translate:vergessen zu] - to forget to
- [translate:sich entscheiden zu] - to decide to

- [translate:planen zu] - to plan to
- [translate:versuchen zu] - to try to

10. Infinitive Constructions (um...zu, ohne...zu, anstatt...zu)

um...zu (in order to)

Purpose/Goal:

- [translate:Ich lerne Deutsch, um in Deutschland zu arbeiten.] - I'm learning German in order to work in Germany.
- [translate:Sie spart Geld, um ein Auto zu kaufen.] - She's saving money to buy a car.
- [translate:Wir gehen früh ins Bett, um ausgeschlafen zu sein.] - We go to bed early in order to be well-rested.
- [translate:Er studiert Medizin, um Arzt zu werden.] - He studies medicine in order to become a doctor.

ohne...zu (without)

Action without something:

- [translate:Er verließ das Haus, ohne ein Wort zu sagen.] - He left the house without saying a word.
- [translate:Sie bestand die Prüfung, ohne viel zu lernen.] - She passed the exam without studying much.
- [translate:Ich kann nicht leben, ohne Musik zu hören.] - I can't live without listening to music.
- [translate:Du kannst nicht fahren, ohne den Führerschein zu haben.] - You can't drive without having a license.

anstatt...zu / statt...zu (instead of)

Alternative action:

- [translate:Er blieb zu Hause, anstatt zur Arbeit zu gehen.] - He stayed home instead of going to work.
- [translate:Sie schaute fern, statt ihre Hausaufgaben zu machen.] - She watched TV instead of doing her homework.
- [translate:Wir nehmen den Bus, anstatt zu laufen.] - We take the bus instead of walking.
- [translate:Sie kauft das teure Kleid, anstatt zu sparen.] - She buys the expensive dress instead of saving money.

11. Subordinate Clauses (Nebensätze)

Subordinate clauses provide additional information and have the verb at the end.

Causal Clauses (weil, da, denn)

weil (because):

- [translate:Ich bleibe zu Hause, weil ich krank bin.] - I'm staying home because I'm sick.
- [translate:Sie kommt nicht, weil sie arbeiten muss.] - She's not coming because she has to work.

da (since/because - more formal):

- [translate:Da es regnet, nehmen wir den Regenschirm mit.] - Since it's raining, we're taking the umbrella.
- [translate:Da ich müde bin, gehe ich früh ins Bett.] - Since I'm tired, I'm going to bed early.

denn (because - doesn't change word order):

- [translate:Wir fahren mit dem Auto, denn der Bus ist zu langsam.] - We're driving because the bus is too slow.

Conditional Clauses (wenn, falls)

wenn (if/when):

- [translate:Wenn es morgen regnet, bleiben wir zu Hause.] - If it rains tomorrow, we'll stay home.
- [translate:Wenn ich Zeit habe, besuche ich dich.] - If I have time, I'll visit you.
- [translate:Wenn du kommst, freue ich mich.] - If you come, I'll be happy.

falls (in case):

- [translate:Falls du kommst, rufe mich an.] - In case you come, call me.
- [translate:Falls es regnet, nehmen wir Regenschirme mit.] - In case it rains, we'll take umbrellas.

Temporal Clauses

bevor (before):

- [translate:Bevor ich esse, wasche ich mir die Hände.] - Before I eat, I wash my hands.
- [translate:Bevor wir fahren, tanken wir das Auto.] - Before we drive, we fill up the car.

nachdem (after):

- [translate:Nachdem er gegessen hatte, ging er spazieren.] - After he had eaten, he went for a walk.
- [translate:Nachdem wir angekommen sind, rufen wir an.] - After we arrive, we'll call.

während (while):

- [translate:Während ich arbeite, höre ich Musik.] - While I work, I listen to music.
- [translate:Während sie kocht, lese ich die Zeitung.] - While she cooks, I read the newspaper.

seit/seitdem (since):

- [translate:Seit ich in Deutschland wohne, lerne ich Deutsch.] - Since I live in Germany, I've been learning German.
- [translate:Seitdem er hier arbeitet, ist er glücklicher.] - Since he works here, he's happier.

bis (until):

- [translate:Ich warte, bis du kommst.] - I'll wait until you come.
- [translate:Wir bleiben hier, bis es aufhört zu regnen.] - We'll stay here until it stops raining.

Concessive Clauses (obwohl, trotzdem)

obwohl (although):

- [translate:Obwohl es kalt ist, gehe ich spazieren.] - Although it's cold, I'm going for a walk.
- [translate:Obwohl sie müde war, arbeitete sie weiter.] - Although she was tired, she continued working.

trotzdem (nevertheless - doesn't change word order):

- [translate:Es ist kalt. Trotzdem gehe ich spazieren.] - It's cold. Nevertheless, I'm going for a walk.

12. Relative Clauses (Relativsätze)

Relative clauses provide additional information about a noun and use relative pronouns.

Nominative Relative Pronouns (der, die, das)

- [translate:Der Mann, der dort steht, ist mein Lehrer.] - The man who stands there is my teacher.
- [translate:Die Frau, die das Buch liest, ist meine Mutter.] - The woman who reads the book is my mother.
- [translate:Das Kind, das spielt, ist sehr glücklich.] - The child who plays is very happy.
- [translate:Die Leute, die hier wohnen, sind nett.] - The people who live here are nice.

Accusative Relative Pronouns (den, die, das)

- [translate:Der Film, den ich gesehen habe, war sehr gut.] - The movie that I saw was very good.
- [translate:Die Musik, die du hörst, gefällt mir.] - The music that you listen to, I like.
- [translate:Das Buch, das er liest, ist interessant.] - The book that he reads is interesting.
- [translate:Die Bücher, die wir kaufen, sind teuer.] - The books that we buy are expensive.

Dative Relative Pronouns (dem, der, dem)

- [translate:Der Mann, dem ich geholfen habe, war sehr dankbar.] - The man whom I helped was very grateful.
- [translate:Die Frau, der ich das Buch gegeben habe, ist Lehrerin.] - The woman to whom I gave the book is a teacher.
- [translate:Das Kind, dem wir das Spielzeug geschenkt haben, freut sich.] - The child to whom we gave the toy is happy.

Genitive Relative Pronouns (dessen, deren)

- [translate:Der Mann, dessen Auto gestohlen wurde, ruft die Polizei.] - The man whose car was stolen calls the police.
- [translate:Die Frau, deren Kinder hier spielen, wohnt nebenan.] - The woman whose children play here lives next door.
- [translate:Das Haus, dessen Dach kaputt ist, wird repariert.] - The house whose roof is broken is being repaired.

Relative Clauses with Prepositions

- [translate:Das Haus, in dem ich wohne, ist sehr alt.] - The house in which I live is very old.
- [translate:Der Freund, mit dem ich spreche, kommt aus Italien.] - The friend with whom I speak comes from Italy.
- [translate:Die Stadt, aus der sie kommt, ist sehr schön.] - The city from which she comes is very beautiful.
- [translate:Der Stuhl, auf dem ich sitze, ist bequem.] - The chair on which I sit is comfortable.

13. Adjective Endings (Adjektivdeklinaton)

Adjective endings change based on case, gender, number, and the type of article used.

After Definite Articles (der, die, das)

Nominative:

- [translate:der große Hund] - the big dog
- [translate:die schöne Blume] - the beautiful flower
- [translate:das neue Auto] - the new car
- [translate:die netten Leute] - the nice people

Accusative:

- [translate:den großen Hund] - the big dog (acc.)
- [translate:die schöne Blume] - the beautiful flower (acc.)
- [translate:das neue Auto] - the new car (acc.)
- [translate:die netten Leute] - the nice people (acc.)

Dative:

- [translate:dem großen Hund] - to/with the big dog
- [translate:der schönen Blume] - to/with the beautiful flower
- [translate:dem neuen Auto] - to/with the new car
- [translate:den netten Leuten] - to/with the nice people

After Indefinite Articles (ein, eine)

Nominative:

- [translate:ein großer Hund] - a big dog
- [translate:eine schöne Blume] - a beautiful flower
- [translate:ein neues Auto] - a new car

Accusative:

- [translate:einen großen Hund] - a big dog (acc.)
- [translate:eine schöne Blume] - a beautiful flower (acc.)
- [translate:ein neues Auto] - a new car (acc.)

Dative:

- [translate:einem großen Hund] - to/with a big dog
- [translate:einer schönen Blume] - to/with a beautiful flower
- [translate:einem neuen Auto] - to/with a new car

Without Articles

- [translate:großer Hund] - big dog
- [translate:schöne Blume] - beautiful flower
- [translate:neues Auto] - new car
- [translate:nette Leute] - nice people

In Sentences

- [translate:Ich sehe einen großen schwarzen Hund.] - I see a big black dog.
- [translate:Das ist ein sehr interessantes Buch.] - That is a very interesting book.
- [translate:Wir haben frisches deutsches Brot gekauft.] - We bought fresh German bread.
- [translate:Sie trägt ein schönes rotes Kleid.] - She wears a beautiful red dress.

14. Prepositions and Their Cases

Accusative Prepositions

- **durch** (through): [translate:Wir gehen durch den Park.] - We walk through the park.
- **für** (for): [translate:Das Geschenk ist für meinen Vater.] - The gift is for my father.
- **ohne** (without): [translate:Ich gehe ohne meinen Bruder.] - I go without my brother.
- **gegen** (against): [translate:Wir spielen gegen die anderen.] - We play against the others.
- **um** (around/at): [translate:Wir treffen uns um acht Uhr.] - We meet at eight o'clock.
- **bis** (until): [translate:Ich arbeite bis fünf Uhr.] - I work until five o'clock.

Dative Prepositions

- **aus** (from/out of): [translate:Ich komme aus Deutschland.] - I come from Germany.
- **außer** (except): [translate:Alle kommen, außer Maria.] - Everyone comes except Maria.
- **bei** (at/with): [translate:Ich wohne bei meinen Eltern.] - I live with my parents.
- **mit** (with): [translate:Ich fahre mit dem Bus.] - I travel by bus.
- **nach** (to/after): [translate:Wir fahren nach Berlin.] - We're going to Berlin.
- **seit** (since/for): [translate:Ich lerne seit einem Jahr Deutsch.] - I've been learning German for a year.
- **von** (from/of): [translate:Das Buch ist von meinem Lehrer.] - The book is from my teacher.
- **zu** (to): [translate:Ich gehe zu meiner Großmutter.] - I'm going to my grandmother.

Two-Way Prepositions (Wechselpräpositionen)

Accusative (movement/direction):

- [translate:Ich gehe in die Schule.] - I go to school.
- [translate:Der Ball fliegt über die Mauer.] - The ball flies over the wall.
- [translate:Sie stellt das Buch auf den Tisch.] - She puts the book on the table.

Dative (location/position):

- [translate:Ich bin in der Schule.] - I am in school.
- [translate:Der Ball ist über der Mauer.] - The ball is above the wall.
- [translate:Das Buch liegt auf dem Tisch.] - The book lies on the table.

Two-Way Prepositions List

- **an** (at/on): [translate:an der Wand] - on the wall
- **auf** (on): [translate:auf dem Tisch] - on the table
- **hinter** (behind): [translate:hinter dem Haus] - behind the house
- **in** (in): [translate:in der Stadt] - in the city
- **neben** (next to): [translate:neben der Bank] - next to the bank
- **über** (over/above): [translate:über dem Bett] - above the bed
- **unter** (under): [translate:unter dem Stuhl] - under the chair
- **vor** (in front of): [translate:vor der Schule] - in front of the school
- **zwischen** (between): [translate:zwischen den Häusern] - between the houses

Genitive Prepositions

- **während** (during): [translate:während der Arbeit] - during work
- **wegen** (because of): [translate:wegen des Regens] - because of the rain
- **trotz** (despite): [translate:trotz des schlechten Wetters] - despite the bad weather
- **statt/anstatt** (instead of): [translate:statt des Autos] - instead of the car

15. Conjunctions (Konjunktionen)

Coordinating Conjunctions (don't change word order)

und (and):

- [translate:Ich trinke Kaffee und esse Kuchen.] - I drink coffee and eat cake.
- [translate:Sie ist intelligent und fleißig.] - She is intelligent and hardworking.

oder (or):

- [translate:Möchtest du Tee oder Kaffee?] - Would you like tea or coffee?
- [translate:Wir können ins Kino oder ins Theater gehen.] - We can go to the cinema or to the theater.

aber (but):

- [translate:Er ist müde, aber er arbeitet weiter.] - He's tired, but he continues working.
- [translate:Das Haus ist schön, aber sehr teuer.] - The house is beautiful, but very expensive.

denn (because):

- [translate:Ich bleibe zu Hause, denn ich bin krank.] - I stay home because I'm sick.
- [translate:Sie kommt nicht mit, denn sie hat keine Zeit.] - She's not coming along because she has no time.

sondern (but rather):

- [translate:Ich trinke nicht Kaffee, sondern Tee.] - I don't drink coffee, but rather tea.
- [translate:Er ist nicht faul, sondern sehr fleißig.] - He's not lazy, but rather very hardworking.

Subordinating Conjunctions (verb goes to the end)

dass (that):

- [translate:Ich denke, dass er Recht hat.] - I think that he's right.
- [translate:Sie sagt, dass sie morgen kommt.] - She says that she's coming tomorrow.

weil (because):

- [translate:Ich komme nicht, weil ich krank bin.] - I'm not coming because I'm sick.
- [translate:Sie ist glücklich, weil sie Urlaub hat.] - She's happy because she has vacation.

wenn (if/when):

- [translate:Wenn es regnet, nehme ich den Regenschirm.] - If it rains, I take the umbrella.
- [translate:Wenn ich Zeit habe, besuche ich dich.] - If I have time, I'll visit you.

obwohl (although):

- [translate:Obwohl es kalt ist, gehe ich spazieren.] - Although it's cold, I go for a walk.
- [translate:Obwohl er müde war, half er mir.] - Although he was tired, he helped me.

damit (so that):

- [translate:Ich lerne Deutsch, damit ich in Deutschland arbeiten kann.] - I learn German so that I can work in Germany.
- [translate:Sie spricht laut, damit alle sie hören können.] - She speaks loudly so that everyone can hear her.

als (when - past events):

- [translate:Als ich jung war, spielte ich gern Fußball.] - When I was young, I liked to play football.
- [translate:Als er ankam, regnete es.] - When he arrived, it was raining.

16. Da-Compounds and Wo-Compounds

These replace preposition + pronoun combinations when referring to things (not people).

Da-Compounds (replace preposition + es/das)

Instead of [translate:mit es], we say [translate:damit]

Common Da-Compounds:

- [translate:dafür] (for that): [translate:Ich interessiere mich dafür.] - I'm interested in that.
- [translate:darüber] (about that): [translate:Wir sprechen darüber.] - We talk about that.
- [translate:darán] (on/at that): [translate:Sie denkt daran.] - She thinks about that.
- [translate:damit] (with that): [translate:Er arbeitet damit.] - He works with that.
- [translate:davon] (of/from that): [translate:Ich weiß nichts davon.] - I know nothing about that.
- [translate:dazu] (to that): [translate:Was sagst du dazu?] - What do you say to that?

Wo-Compounds (for questions with prepositions)

Common Wo-Compounds:

- [translate:wofür] (for what): [translate:Wofür interessierst du dich?] - What are you interested in?
- [translate:worüber] (about what): [translate:Worüber sprechen wir?] - What are we talking about?
- [translate:worán] (on/at what): [translate:Woran denkst du?] - What are you thinking about?
- [translate:womit] (with what): [translate:Womit arbeitest du?] - What are you working with?
- [translate:wovon] (of/from what): [translate:Wovon erzählst du?] - What are you talking about?
- [translate:wozu] (to what/why): [translate:Wozu brauchst du das?] - What do you need that for?

Examples in Context

- [translate:Denkst du an die Prüfung? - Ja, ich denke daran.] - Are you thinking about the exam? - Yes, I'm thinking about it.
- [translate:Interessierst du dich für Sport? - Ja, ich interessiere mich dafür.] - Are you interested in sports? - Yes, I'm interested in it.
- [translate:Wofür gibst du dein Geld aus?] - What do you spend your money on?
- [translate:Worauf wartest du?] - What are you waiting for?

17. Weak Nouns (Schwache Nomen)

Some masculine nouns add -(e)n in all cases except nominative singular.

Examples of Weak Nouns

der Student (student):

- **Nom. Sg:** [translate:der Student] - the student
- **Acc. Sg:** [translate:den Studenten] - the student (acc.)
- **Dat. Sg:** [translate:dem Studenten] - to the student
- **Gen. Sg:** [translate:des Studenten] - of the student
- **Plural:** [translate:die Studenten] - the students

der Mensch (human):

- [translate:Ich kenne diesen Menschen.] - I know this person.
- [translate:Wir helfen dem Menschen.] - We help the person.
- [translate:Das Leben des Menschen ist kurz.] - Human life is short.

Common Weak Nouns

- [translate:der Herr] → [translate:den Herrn] - gentleman/sir
- [translate:der Name] → [translate:den Namen] - name
- [translate:der Kunde] → [translate:den Kunden] - customer
- [translate:der Kollege] → [translate:den Kollegen] - colleague
- [translate:der Nachbar] → [translate:den Nachbarn] - neighbor
- [translate:der Präsident] → [translate:den Präsidenten] - president
- [translate:der Junge] → [translate:den Jungen] - boy
- [translate:der Löwe] → [translate:den Löwen] - lion

In Sentences

- [translate:Der Kunde möchte bezahlen.] - The customer wants to pay.
- [translate:Ich spreche mit dem Kunden.] - I speak with the customer.
- [translate:Die Meinung des Kunden ist wichtig.] - The customer's opinion is important.

18. Comparative and Superlative

Comparative (Komparativ)

Regular formation: adjective + -er

- [translate:groß → größer] - big → bigger
- [translate:klein → kleiner] - small → smaller
- [translate:schnell → schneller] - fast → faster

Examples:

- [translate:Das Haus ist größer als das Auto.] - The house is bigger than the car.
- [translate:Heute ist es kälter als gestern.] - Today it's colder than yesterday.

- [translate:Sie läuft schneller als ich.] - She runs faster than I do.

Superlative (Superlativ)

Formation: am + adjective + -(e)sten or der/die/das + adjective + -(e)ste

With "am":

- [translate:Er läuft am schnellsten.] - He runs the fastest.
- [translate:Dieses Auto ist am teuersten.] - This car is the most expensive.
- [translate:Im Winter ist es am kältesten.] - In winter it's the coldest.

With definite article:

- [translate:Das ist das größte Haus.] - That's the biggest house.
- [translate:Sie ist die intelligenteste Studentin.] - She's the most intelligent student.
- [translate:Das war der schönste Tag.] - That was the most beautiful day.

Irregular Comparisons

- [translate:gut → besser → am besten] - good → better → best
- [translate:viel → mehr → am meisten] - much → more → most
- [translate:gern → lieber → am liebsten] - gladly → rather → most gladly
- [translate:hoch → höher → am höchsten] - high → higher → highest
- [translate:nah → näher → am nächsten] - near → nearer → nearest

Examples with Irregulars

- [translate:Dieses Buch ist besser als das andere.] - This book is better than the other one.
- [translate:Ich trinke lieber Tee als Kaffee.] - I prefer drinking tea to coffee.
- [translate:Das ist das beste Restaurant in der Stadt.] - That's the best restaurant in the city.

19. Past Participles as Adjectives

Past participles can function as adjectives with appropriate endings.

Examples with Endings

- [translate:das geschriebene Buch] - the written book
- [translate:die gelesene Zeitung] - the read newspaper
- [translate:der reparierte Computer] - the repaired computer
- [translate:die geöffnete Tür] - the opened door
- [translate:das verkaufte Auto] - the sold car

In Sentences

- [translate:Ich sehe ein geöffnetes Fenster.] - I see an opened window.
- [translate:Das ist ein gut geschriebener Brief.] - That's a well-written letter.
- [translate:Die reparierten Autos stehen dort.] - The repaired cars stand there.
- [translate:Sie trägt ein gekauftes Kleid.] - She wears a bought dress.

Different Cases

Nominative:

- [translate:Das gebackene Brot schmeckt gut.] - The baked bread tastes good.

Accusative:

- [translate:Wir essen das gebackene Brot.] - We eat the baked bread.

Dative:

- [translate:Ich danke dem erfahrenen Lehrer.] - I thank the experienced teacher.

20. Verbs with Fixed Prepositions

Many German verbs require specific prepositions that must be memorized.

Common Verb-Preposition Combinations

sich interessieren für (to be interested in):

- [translate:Ich interessiere mich für Sport.] - I'm interested in sports.
- [translate:Wofür interessierst du dich?] - What are you interested in?

denken an (to think about):

- [translate:Ich denke an dich.] - I think about you.
- [translate:Denkst du an die Prüfung?] - Are you thinking about the exam?

warten auf (to wait for):

- [translate:Wir warten auf den Bus.] - We wait for the bus.
- [translate:Auf wen wartest du?] - Who are you waiting for?

sich freuen auf (to look forward to):

- [translate:Ich freue mich auf die Ferien.] - I look forward to the vacation.
- [translate:Worauf freust du dich?] - What are you looking forward to?

sich freuen über (to be happy about):

- [translate:Sie freut sich über das Geschenk.] - She's happy about the gift.
- [translate:Worüber freust du dich?] - What are you happy about?

sich ärgern über (to be annoyed about):

- [translate:Er ärgert sich über den Lärm.] - He's annoyed about the noise.
- [translate:Worüber ärgerst du dich?] - What are you annoyed about?

teilnehmen an (to participate in):

- [translate:Wir nehmen an dem Kurs teil.] - We participate in the course.
- [translate:Woran nimmst du teil?] - What are you participating in?

sich entscheiden für (to decide on):

- [translate:Sie entscheidet sich für das rote Kleid.] - She decides on the red dress.
- [translate:Wofür hast du dich entschieden?] - What did you decide on?

sprechen über (to talk about):

- [translate:Wir sprechen über das Wetter.] - We talk about the weather.
- [translate:Worüber sprecht ihr?] - What are you talking about?

sich gewöhnen an (to get used to):

- [translate:Ich gewöhne mich an das Klima.] - I'm getting used to the climate.
- [translate:Woran gewöhnst du dich?] - What are you getting used to?

More Verb-Preposition Combinations

- [translate:sich verlieben in] - to fall in love with
- [translate:leiden unter] - to suffer from
- [translate:sich kümmern um] - to take care of
- [translate:sich bewerben um] - to apply for
- [translate:sich bedanken für] - to thank for
- [translate:sich verabschieden von] - to say goodbye to
- [translate:sich erinnern an] - to remember
- [translate:hoffen auf] - to hope for

Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Case Practice

Translate the following sentences, paying attention to the cases:

1. The man gives the woman a book.
2. I see the children in the garden.
3. She lives with her parents.
4. The color of the house is beautiful.

Exercise 2: Tense Practice

Put the following sentences into different tenses:

[translate:Ich gehe ins Kino.] (Present)

- Perfect: _____
- Imperfect: _____
- Future: _____

Exercise 3: Modal Verb Practice

Complete with the correct modal verb:

1. Ich _____ schwimmen. (can)
2. Du _____ pünktlich sein. (should)
3. Wir _____ ins Kino gehen. (want to)

Exercise 4: Word Order Practice

Correct the word order:

1. Gestern ich war im Kino.
2. Ich denke, dass er kommt morgen.
3. Er steht auf um 7 Uhr.

Exercise 5: Preposition Practice

Fill in the correct preposition and case:

1. Ich gehe _____ Schule. (to)
2. Das Buch liegt _____ Tisch. (on)
3. Wir kommen _____ Deutschland. (from)

Study Tips for Success

1. **Practice Daily:** Dedicate at least 30 minutes daily to grammar practice
2. **Use Real Contexts:** Apply grammar rules in meaningful sentences
3. **Focus on Patterns:** Look for patterns rather than memorizing individual rules
4. **Practice Speaking:** Use grammar actively in conversation
5. **Review Regularly:** Revisit topics you've already learned
6. **Use Authentic Materials:** Read German texts and listen to German media
7. **Make Mistakes:** Don't be afraid to make errors - they're part of learning
8. **Keep a Grammar Journal:** Write down new structures and examples
9. **Practice with Native Speakers:** Apply your knowledge in real conversations
10. **Be Patient:** German grammar takes time to master - stay consistent

Conclusion

This comprehensive B1 German grammar notebook covers all essential topics needed for intermediate German proficiency. Regular practice with these structures will help you communicate more effectively and pass your B1 exam successfully.

Remember: Grammar is a tool for communication, not an end in itself. Focus on using these structures to express your ideas clearly and confidently.

Viel Erfolg beim Lernen! (Good luck with your studies!)

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